

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager, Link, Local Payment Methods.*

Positioning, payments infrastructure builder with 13 years of delivery across fintech, regulated SaaS, and consumer-facing products, now focused on scaling global payment networks.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY STRIPE

The Link team is solving something genuinely hard: abstracting away the fragmentation of local payment methods so that merchants get higher conversion and consumers get to pay the way they want, without either side having to think about it. That is a problem I recognise from my own work building Kvitt, a mobile P2P payments product that ended up inside the girocard ecosystem, the infrastructure complexity is invisible to the user only because someone upstream made hard calls about routing, trust, and fallback. The specific challenge of building "localized experiences globally" is not a marketing phrase here; it is a real coordination problem between consumer UX, merchant economics, and payment-scheme compliance. *That is exactly the class of problem where I do my best work.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case discovery
- **GitHub Copilot**, accelerated prototyping cycles
- **Cursor/VSCode**, LLM-assisted implementation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototype iteration
- **GPT**, research, synthesis, and structured drafting
- **n8n**, agentic workflow design and automation
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-ready decks from structured notes

- **Framer**, design-heavy interactive prototypes

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Docker, OpenShift, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, SQL, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), MongoDB, Kafka, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, across regulated platforms in defence, public-sector analytics, healthcare, and payments.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A two-sided B2B staffing marketplace that replaces the construction-sector headhunter with an LLM-driven funnel.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protects both parties until commitment is established.
- WhatsApp and Telegram as primary product surface; LLM agents handle qualification and routing across the funnel.
- Built zero-to-one as sole PM and developer; funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.
- Demonstrates the ability to ship an end-to-end consumer-facing transactional product under resource constraints, directly relevant to iterating on Link's local payment method UX.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT STRIPE

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow merchant onboarding and consumer checkout flows for two or three local payment methods, map the current integration surface against the roadmap, and identify where friction is being absorbed by operations rather than resolved by product.

WEEK 2

Instrument, slice, validate.

Pull the SQL I need to confirm or refute the hypotheses from week one, slice conversion by method and market, and propose the first small experiment worth running before building anything large.

WEEK 3+

Ship, close loops.

Drive the first scoped milestone, whether that is a new payment method in a target market, an improved fallback UX, or a merchant-facing capability, through design, engineering, and GTM, and establish the measurement baseline for what follows.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Stripe Link Team,

Payments infrastructure is only as good as what the end user never notices. I built Kvitt, a mobile P2P payments product, from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem, which means I learned early that consumer trust in a payment experience is lost in the edge cases: the declined method, the confusing fallback, the moment the UI asks the user to make a decision that the product should have made for them. The Link team's mission to give consumers the freedom to pay with their preferred methods across millions of merchants, without exposing that complexity to either side, is the right framing for this problem.

My path since Kvitt has run through every layer of the regulated product stack. At EMIL Group I shipped a Claims Center from concept to production in an 18-person organisation that was losing both its engineers and its client trust; I restructured it into three lean teams and cut attrition from near-total to a single departure. At Rohde & Schwarz I redirected the data platform strategy for a multinational defence programme based on instrumented workflow analysis, the "beautiful" UI-led workflow recorded exactly zero clicks, so we pivoted to developer-code-first and pipeline runs increased 200%. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration simultaneously while containerising a bare-metal system and cutting data-update time by 75%. These are not payments stories, but they are the same story: rigorous discovery, instrument before you build, protect the user from complexity.

The local payment methods space adds a dimension I find genuinely interesting: the strategy is not just about UX or engineering, it is about market-by-market scheme relationships, consumer trust patterns, and the economics of method mix for the merchant. The experience I bring from Scheidt & Bachmann's POS and forecourt payment systems, moving research through a SAFe organisation into production, and from the AOK procurement webshop migration maps directly

onto the coordination work that comes with expanding a network like Link into new markets and new method categories. I am comfortable sitting at the boundary between merchant-facing product decisions and consumer-facing experience design, because both sides of that equation need to be right for conversion to move.

I work with data as a first-order product input, not as a reporting afterthought. I write the SQL I need, define the KPIs before the sprint starts, and check them after it ends. At construct8 I built funnel and conversion analysis in SQL from the start, as a solo founder, because I was not willing to make roadmap decisions without measurement. At the Bundesagentur I instrumented the pipeline before proposing the strategy shift. At Rohde & Schwarz the workflow analysis preceded the pivot. The pattern is consistent: I want to know what is actually happening before I decide what to build next.

Stripe's platform is the infrastructure layer that a large fraction of global commerce runs on. Working on Link's local payment methods means operating at the intersection of that infrastructure and the consumer moments where trust is either earned or lost. I would bring ownership, data discipline, and the ability to hold the merchant and consumer perspectives simultaneously, and I would be glad to talk through what that looks like in practice.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager and Product Owner with 13 years of delivery in regulated and complex environments, payments, insurance, public-sector analytics, and defence AI. Consistent pattern: rigorous discovery before committing to build, instrumented decisions, and cross-functional ownership from strategy through shipping. Now targeting consumer and infrastructure-layer payments, where those disciplines compound.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Payments and consumer product: payment flow and PSP integration design, P2P and consumer payment UX, edge-case handling, merchant-facing product decisions, girocard ecosystem, POS and forecourt systems.

Product management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research and interviews, go-to-market support, product lifecycle management.

Data and SQL: funnel and conversion analysis, KPI definition, SQL, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL, Dagster, dbt.

Platform and delivery: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, GitOps, Docker, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

AI products and tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Agile and scaled delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, PI planning, backlog refinement, velocity and burndown, Jira, Confluence.

Stakeholder and leadership: cross-functional team leadership (15+ engineers and data scientists), C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Governance: GDPR/DSGVO, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget and financial planning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

Led GitOps delivery with ArgoCD (rollout time: days → 30 min) and redirected platform strategy based on instrumented workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs 200%; cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists across the FCAS European programme.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Integrated test automation into Jenkins, introduced Dagster and dbt (data update time -75%), containerised a bare-metal system, and carried a full UI relaunch and large ETL migration simultaneously. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023-2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features against agreed success measures; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM/KIS interface reducing digital anamnesis from 30 min to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022-2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL PAYMENTS AND POS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT IDENTITY PLATFORM 2021-2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE PROCUREMENT 2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019-2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK INFRASTRUCTURE 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero to one: two-sided B2B marketplace, anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp/Telegram product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, SQL-based conversion analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer encryption product installing in under two minutes to satisfy enterprise buyers; later Chair of the Board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY AND AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Lab to investor rounds: owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built mobile group-based P2P payments platform from zero to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · STRIPE

→